

Tax & Depreciation Essentials Checklist — Investors (ACT)

What to have in place, and what's changing, before you lodge your next return.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — this is NOT financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or tax agent for advice specific to your situation.

Section 1 — Records to Keep From Day One

- ☐ ☐ **A tax depreciation schedule from a qualified quantity surveyor** — Division 43 (building) and Division 40 (plant and equipment) deductions.
- ☐ ☐ **Receipts for repairs vs. improvements — kept separately.** Repairs are often immediately deductible; improvements form part of your CGT cost base.
- ☐ ☐ **ACT Revenue Office land tax and rates assessments** — keep every annual assessment.
- ☐ ☐ **Conveyance duty receipts.**
- ☐ ☐ **Records of your accountant fees and depreciation schedule costs.**

Section 2 — ACT Land Tax and Rates Obligations

- ☐ ☐ **Understand you'll pay land tax on any rental or vacant property that isn't your principal place of residence.** This is separate from general rates, which apply to all ACT property owners regardless of occupancy status.
- ☐ ☐ **Budget for both rates and land tax as ongoing annual costs** — the ACT's tax model relies more heavily on these recurring charges than one-off transaction taxes, reflecting the territory's long-term shift away from stamp duty.
- ☐ ☐ **If you're a foreign entity, budget for the foreign ownership surcharge on land tax,** in addition to the 7% surcharge duty paid at purchase — confirm current land tax surcharge settings with the ACT Revenue Office.

Section 3 — Understanding the Changing CGT Environment

- ☐ ☐ **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing,** with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from **1 July 2027** — confirm the finalised current position with your accountant.
- ☐ ☐ **If planning to sell, get advice on timing relative to the 2027 changeover.**

Section 4 — Depreciation Schedule Timing

- ☐ ☐ **Get your depreciation schedule prepared as early as possible after settlement.**
- ☐ ☐ **Update it after any renovations or major asset additions.**
- ☐ ☐ **Don't assume an older ACT property has no deductions available** — plant and equipment deductions can still apply, and given Canberra's climate, heating systems are often a significant depreciable asset worth confirming with your quantity surveyor.

Section 5 — Questions to Bring to Your Accountant

- ☐ ☐ What is my current ACT land tax and rates position for this property?
- ☐ ☐ Does the foreign ownership surcharge apply to my situation, for either duty or land tax?
- ☐ ☐ How will the 2027 CGT changes affect a future sale of this property?
- ☐ ☐ Is my depreciation schedule up to date with any renovations or asset purchases since it was last prepared?

Quick Reference — ACT Investor Tax Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax	Applies to non-principal-place-of-residence properties
Rates	Apply to all ACT properties
Foreign ownership surcharge (duty)	7%
CGT discount changes	Cost-base indexation + minimum tax from 1 July 2027
Depreciation schedule	Div 40 (plant/equipment) + Div 43 (building) — quantity surveyor required

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